AISK's robotics team has already competed at Worlds. Hack 876 is one day to build something new.



Hack 876 is a one-day build competition bringing about 80 Jamaican secondary-school students together to turn ideas into working prototypes.

01 ALREADY ON BOARD

Campion College and Hillel Academy are already in.

The inaugural Hack 876 is taking shape. We would like AISK students in the room with them.



Campion College

CONFIRMED SCHOOL



Hillel Academy

CONFIRMED SCHOOL

7 CONFIRMED JUDGES

Working at Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp.

FREE FOR STUDENTS

No cost to apply. Food is provided on the day.

VENUE CONFIRMED

Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston.

SUPPORTED BY

Lev Beauty, Vault Motors, Norus Technologies, Frankies.

02 WHY AISK

AISK already builds.

AISK Hurricane, FIRST Tech Challenge team 17980, won the Inspire Award at the Jamaica championship in 2023–24 and has competed at the FIRST World Championship two seasons running.

Hack 876 brings together students from across Kingston for one day: mixed teams, a fixed deadline, industry mentors and judges who ask teams to explain their decisions. It is a chance for AISK students to build alongside peers they would not otherwise meet.

Robotics

Inspire Award 2023–24, Innovate Award 2022–23, and the World Championship in 2023–24 and 2024–25.

Team Jamaica

An AISK student on Jamaica's 2024 Robotics Olympics team, and AISK in the 2026 delegation.

Clubs

A Coding Hub, a Drone Club, a STEM Club and Hurricane Hut, a student-run store.

A laptop each

Students in Grades 5 to 12 bring their own MacBook daily, which suits a build-your-own-device event.

> **"Our students shape the future."**
>
> American International School of Kingston, vision · aisk.com

One day. Build something real.

~80 TOTAL BUILDERS

3–4 PER TEAM

1 DAY

A hackathon is an event where small teams build something from scratch in a single day, then present it to judges. No programming experience is needed: teams also need students who design, research, write and present. Mentors who work in industry help throughout the day.

STEP 1

Think

Find a real problem worth solving.

STEP 2

Build

Turn the idea into a working prototype.

STEP 3

Ship

Get it running before the clock stops.

STEP 4

Present

Demo it to judges and explain the decisions.

Websites · Apps · AI tools · Games · Hardware · Data projects · Automations · Agents · Interactive experiences

Not an AI-only hackathon. Teams build whatever the problem needs.

04 WHAT STUDENTS GAIN

More than a project.

It won't decide anyone's career. It gives students a useful early signal about whether building technology excites them.

Teamwork
Working with people who think differently.

Scoping
Learning what can really be built in a day.

Technical problem solving
Turning a concept into something that works.

Decision making
Choosing between ideas under real constraints.

Communication
Explaining what they built to judges and peers.

Resilience
Shipping something even when it isn't perfect.

Exposure
Meeting students and professionals beyond their usual circle.

Confidence
Moving from using technology to making it.

05 PARTICIPATION

AISK in the room.

Hack 876 is for students in 5th Form through Upper 6th Form. Participating schools recommend students, and recommended students apply. No place is assumed until applications and selection happen.

8–12

PLANNING RANGE · NOT GUARANTEED

For early planning, a cohort of roughly 8–12 AISK students fits the scale we're considering. With about 80 places across participating schools, final representation depends on applications and overall capacity.

Teams of 3–4. Students can apply solo or with friends, and teams may mix schools. Final team-formation rules are still being finalized.

WHAT WE'D LIKE FROM AISK

1. A 20-minute call with Dr. Powell, or a colleague she nominates.
2. Support in principle for AISK students in Grades 11 and 12, which match Hack 876's 5th Form to Upper 6th Form, to take part.
3. A school-side contact, possibly the Grades 11 and 12 coordinator or the robotics advisers.
4. Help reaching students in robotics, the Coding Hub, the Drone and STEM Clubs, and Hurricane Hut.
5. Guidance on timing around IB commitments, permissions and communication with parents.

We're not asking AISK for financial support, or to organize anything. Hack 876 runs the event, the applications, the judging and the participant materials.

06 COMPETITION

Build it. Present it. Compete for it.

Prizes across overall placement and special categories. The exact package will keep developing as sponsors are finalized, and participating schools will get updates.

OVERALL PLACEMENT

Hack 876 Winner
The whole thing. Best overall build.
iPad per student (up to 4)

Second Place
So close. Still brilliant.
AirPods Pro per student (up to 4)

Third Place
On the podium.
US$150 gift card per student (up to 4)

SPECIAL AWARDS

Best Design
Looks great. Feels even better.
US$50 gift card per student (up to 4)

Boldest Idea
The swing nobody else took.
US$200 team project grant

People's Choice
Voted by the room.
US$50 gift card per student (up to 4)

Categories are set. Prize items are tentative and may change. Prizes are a bonus, not the reason to come.

07 WORKING WITH AISK

Twenty minutes to start.

We would like AISK to be part of the first Hack 876. The first step is a short call with the school's leadership.

PREPARED FOR

Dr. Christie Powell

Middle and High School Principal · AISK

American International School of Kingston

We'd welcome 20 minutes with Dr. Powell, or a colleague she nominates, such as the Grades 11 and 12 coordinator or the robotics team's advisers.



The Hack 876 organizing team runs event operations, applications and all official communication with students and parents.

This is an invitation. The American International School of Kingston has not confirmed participation, nobody at the school has accepted a role, and student places are not guaranteed.

THE ONE THING WE'RE ASKING FOR NOW

A 20-minute call with Dr. Powell, or a colleague she nominates.

Reply to the email this came with, or write to info@hack876.com, and we'll work around your timetable.

We'll fill in the details together.

AISK doesn't need every answer today to join the conversation.

FIRST
A 20-minute call with Dr. Powell or a colleague she nominates.

IF AISK AGREES
Support in principle, and a school-side contact.

THEN
Teachers share the opportunity, and Grade 11 and 12 students apply.

BEFORE THE EVENT
Accepted students and their families receive consent forms.

EVENT DAY
Hack 876.

DECIDED

- One-day build competition
- Venue: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston
- 5th Form through Upper 6th Form
- About 80 places
- Schools recommend, students apply
- Applications are open

PLANNED

- Tentative date: Saturday, February 20, 2027
- A 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM day
- Lunch on the day
- Overall and special prize categories
- Industry judges and mentors

BEING FINALIZED

- Confirming the date
- School-level allocations and team rules
- Cost and transport
- Prize items
- Family details: supervision, food, emergency contacts

Participating schools and applicants will receive detailed information as each part of the event is finalized.

AISK's vision is that its students shape the future. Let's give a few Hurricanes one day to build it.

HACK 876 · KINGSTON, JAMAICA · FEB 20, 2027 (TENTATIVE)

info@hack876.com

ABOUT AISK: SOURCES

1. AISK Robotics: AISK Hurricane, FTC team 17980
2. Jamaica Gleaner: Jamaican team takes bronze at world robotics olympics (October 1, 2024)
3. Jamaica Gleaner: JA wins gold, bronze at Robotics Olympics (October 10, 2026)
4. AISK: Extra-curricular activities
5. AISK: Technology
6. AISK: Mission and values

Prepared by Hack 876 for the AISK community. This is not an official American International School of Kingston publication, and AISK's participation has not been confirmed. Dates, allocations and prizes are provisional.